



ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
GRADE SEVEN EXAMINATION, SPECIMEN PAPER.

ENGLISH
PAPER 2

7010/2
1 hour 45 minutes

SPECIMEN PAPER

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Read **all** the instructions carefully.
2. Do **not** open this question paper until you are told to do so by the invigilator.
3. Use a **blue** or **black** pen to write your answers.
4. Write your name, centre number and candidate number on the answer booklet provided.
5. Answer **all** the questions on a separate answer paper. In Section A, choose **either** 1(a) **or** 1(b).
6. Write all sentences in good grammar and punctuate them correctly.
7. **If you do not understand** the instructions, **ask** the invigilator to explain them to you **before you start**.

This Specimen paper consists of 4 printed pages.

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SECTION A: COMPOSITION (20 MARKS)

You are advised to spend **1 hour** on this section.

1 Answer **either** 1 (a) **or** 1 (b)

Either (a)

You have been asked to present a speech on television, marketing your country to the world. The speech is meant to attract tourists to your country. Write the speech you will present. Your speech should be between **80** and **120 words** in length. Use the following points and any other you may think of to write your speech:

- where the country is located
- favourable weather conditions
- peaceful and friendly citizens
- tourist attractions
- good transport network

[20]

Or (b)

Write a composition describing an important cultural activity you once attended. Your composition should be between **80** and **120** words in length. Use the following points and any other you may think of to write your composition:

- name of the cultural activity
- where and when it was held
- who were involved
- what was done during the cultural activity
- importance of the activity

[20]

SECTION B: COMPREHENSION (15 MARKS)

You are advised to **spend 45 minutes** on this section.

Read the following passage very carefully before you attempt any question.

Answer all the questions in full sentences. You are advised to write your sentences in good grammar and punctuate them correctly.

The Baobab: A Wonder Tree

The baobab is Zimbabwe's wonder tree. It looks like a giant carrot planted upside down. In Zimbabwe, baobab trees are protected under the law, reflecting their importance. The tree is a symbol of hope and strength.

The tree is our national heritage and once it is destroyed, it is hard to replace. People are putting the baobab tree under threat by removing its bark to make mats and brooms. As one passes through the Southern Eastern Lowveld, one will not miss the quick business the community is engaged in through the skinning of the baobab tree of its bark. However, the tree can easily get diseases when skinned.

Man and elephants love to eat its fruit. The seeds can be soaked to dissolve the pulp that coats the seed. The liquid is then frozen to produce a refreshing drink commonly known as 'ice lolo'. The pulp powder can also be used as a supplement for energy and digestion. Some people also take its leaves and use them as relish. These also treat fever and diarrhoea.

Mature baobab trees have hollow trunks towards the base which can be used as shops or bus stop shelters. These trees can withstand drought because they store lots of water. Their massive root systems also help to slow down soil erosion.

Adapted from: *'The Manica Post', March 11-17, 2011*, by Abraham Mudefi, Zimpapers.

Questions

- (a) Give a simile used in paragraph 1 to describe a baobab tree. [1]
- (b) What shows that baobab trees are very important in Zimbabwe? [1]
- (c) How are people destroying the baobab tree? [1]
- (d) According to paragraph 2, why should people avoid destroying the baobab tree? [1]
- (e) According to the passage, where is the baobab tree commonly found in Zimbabwe? [1]

[Turn over

- (f) What does the word 'These' in the last sentence in paragraph 3 refer to? [1]
- (g) "Man and elephants love to eat its fruit". Write another word that can replace the word 'Man' in this sentence. [1]
- (h) How is 'ice lolo' produced? [1]
- (i) How do baobab trees resist drought? [1]
- (j) What is the author's main message in this passage? [1]
- (k) In **not more than 50 words**, summarise the uses of various parts of a baobab tree.

Begin your summary as follows:

The bark of a baobab tree is used for

[5]